

GONÇALO MOREIRA NEVES

Commercial leadership for horticultural LED lighting: new markets, channels and growth

Horticultural LED Lighting

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PROFILE

Horticultural LED lighting executive with **17 years** across photobiology research, LED product design, commercial leadership and C-suite operations. At **Valoya** closed the first deal and grew revenue from **EUR 0 to EUR 10M+ in 50+ countries**, building the distributor network and opening Europe, Southeast Asia, Japan and North America. As **co-CEO of Lumatek** (HID and LED) grew the segment **210% in 2025**, reached a 4x run-rate in Q1 2026 and cut costs by ~60%. Founded **Spectron Light Science**, designed three horticultural LED lines and sold the company within **14 months**.

Engineer at the core (M.Sc. Illumination Engineering, Aalto University) and commercial leader in practice: speaks both the spec sheet (spectrum, PPFD, DLI, µmol/J) and the grower's P&L. Brings market expansion, channel and distributor building, pricing and key-account growth across greenhouse horticulture, floriculture and vertical farming.

Based in Lisbon, working in Portuguese, English and Spanish. Open to **CCO and International Commercial Director** roles in horticultural lighting, remote with regular travel.

KEY RESULTS

EUR 0 to EUR 10M+
First deal to scale, 50+ countries via distributors - Valoya

+210% segment growth
2025, then a 4x run-rate in Q1 2026 - Lumatek

Exit in 14 months
Founded, 3 horticultural LED lines, acquired - Spectron Light Science

2 new segments
Beyond legacy channels; new geographies and channels opened - Lumatek

~60% cost cut
Business-wide, with the CFO, COO and CPO - Lumatek

EUR 20M+ new revenue
Two new revenue streams via partnerships - IGS

Japan and North America
Distribution partnerships closed - Valoya

Photobiology repositioning
New streams in seed, breeding and research - Valoya

Published and ISHS member
Lighting units and measurement in plant cultivation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Managing Partner · APTA Advisory

Aug 2026 - present · Lisbon, PT

Independent due diligence and business strategy firm for CEA and horticulture.

- Lead the firm and its service model: CapEx and OpEx due diligence for buyers of lighting, climate and automation; strategy for suppliers.
- Advise boards, investors and operations teams on investment cases, supplier selection, unit economics and value creation; own go-to-market, pricing and partnerships.
- Designed an outcome-linked fee model (share of verified savings, or fixed fee).

co-CEO, Interim Chief of Sales and Marketing · Lumatek

Dec 2024 - Jul 2026 · Lisbon, PT

Commercial transformation and growth of a 20-year horticultural lighting manufacturer (HID and LED).

- After growing the segment **210% in 2025**, reached a **4x 2025 run-rate in Q1 2026** through targeted development and a repositioned product offer.
- Created **two new customer segments**, expanding the addressable market beyond legacy channels.
- Cut overall business costs by **~60%**, partnering with the CFO, COO and CPO.
- Full commercial and cultural restructure: resized teams, closed underperforming markets, opened **new geographies and distribution channels**.
- Made the business data-driven and unified the commercial culture; hired and onboarded marketing and sales talent.

Independent Consultant · Gonçalo Neves Consulting

Apr 2024 - Aug 2026 · Lisbon, PT

Strategic and technical advisory to investors and operators in Agri-Food Tech and CEA (clients under NDA).

- Technical due diligence on CEA companies, products and platforms for investment decisions.
- Competitive market analyses: technology trends, regulation, market share and buyer preferences; advised on go-to-market, pricing and commercial team structure.

VP Business Development and Head of AgriTech Partnerships · IGS

Aug 2021 - Jul 2024 · Edinburgh / Amsterdam

Award-winning vertical farming technology company; IoT-enabled, AI-driven, six patent families.

- Opened **two new revenue streams generating EUR 20M+** (vertical-farming/greenhouse hybrid; young-plant producers and seed/breeding).
- Closed partnerships with **Schneider Electric, Viscon Group, Microsoft**, Plant Lighting and Wageningen University & Research.
- Cut product OpEx by up to 40% and CapEx/m2 by up to 15%; contributed to a **EUR 50M Series B** (EUR 200M+ valuation).

Director of Farm Hardware · Infarm

Mar 2020 - Mar 2021 · Berlin, DE

Hardware leadership at one of Europe's highest-profile vertical farming scale-ups.

- **40% energy cost reduction per plant** via a new HVAC design, 61% rent cost reduction per m2 and +73% output per m2.
- Grew the team from **~40 to 100 people** in one year; 83% labour cost reduction per plant through automation; contributed to a EUR 200M Series D.

Founder and Director · Five ventures

Jun 2016 - Jan 2020 · Amsterdam, NL

Founder and CEO · Spectron Light Science Nov 2016 - Dec 2017
Designed and manufactured **three horticultural LED product lines**; company **acquired by a major horticultural industry player within 14 months**.

Founder and CTO · OneFarm BV Jan 2017 - Jan 2020
Technology and product for large-scale vertical farm rollouts; seed round EUR 1M, assisted a EUR 9M Series A.

Founder and CEO · BemStudio Jun 2016 - May 2020
Engineering and business consulting for AgTech and CEA clients.

Director · A Lab Vertical Farm Jun 2017 - Dec 2019
Ran a community vertical farm; trained ~50 volunteers in CEA.

Guest Lecturer · Breitner Academie Mar - Jun 2017
Urban farming and food-technology innovation.

Director of Business Development · Valoya

Jun 2011 - May 2016 · Helsinki, FI / NL

Photobiology-driven LED grow-light company. Three roles in five years: Technical Manager, Solution Manager, Director of Business Development (minority shareholder).

- Closed the **company's first commercial deal (EUR 300,000+)** and grew revenue from **EUR 0 to EUR 10M+**.
- Expanded to **50+ countries** across Europe, Southeast Asia, Japan and North America; opened the Amsterdam office.
- Developed and launched the first product lines; closed **distribution partnerships in Japan and North America**.
- Opened new revenue streams (seed/breeding, research) by repositioning on photobiology rather than raw efficiency.

Researcher · Aalto University

Apr 2009 - May 2011 · Helsinki, FI

Horticultural and solid-state lighting: use and control of LEDs in plant cultivation (SSHLighting; LEDFlowers).

SKILLS

Commercial

Go-to-market · Market expansion · International market entry · Distributor and partner networks · Pricing · Key accounts · Customer segmentation · Commercial team building · Forecasting and P&L

Horticultural lighting

LED and HID · Photobiology · Spectrum design · PPFD and DLI · µmol/J efficacy · Greenhouse retrofit · Floriculture · Vertical farming · Seed and breeding

Leadership and tools

co-CEO and interim C-suite · Transformation and turnaround · Technical and commercial due diligence · Capital raising · HubSpot · Salesforce · Tableau · Claude, ChatGPT, Perplexity · SAFe, Flight Levels, Kanban

EDUCATION

Oxford Artificial Intelligence Programme
University of Oxford (starting)

Artificial Intelligence Ethics (specialization)
Coursera (in progress)

AI Fundamentals for Non-Data Scientists
Wharton, University of Pennsylvania, Coursera (in progress)

M.Sc.(Tech.) Electrical Engineering
Illumination Engineering and Electrical Building Services - Aalto University, Finland (2010-2012)

M.Sc. (minor) International Design Business Management
Aalto University, Finland (2011-2012)

B.Sc.(Tech.) Electromechanical Engineering
Universidade da Beira Interior, Portugal (2004-2009)

Erasmus exchange, Electromechanical Engineering
TKK, now Aalto, Finland (2009)

CERTIFICATIONS

- Leading SAFe, Gladwell Academy
- Agile for Hardware, Gladwell Academy
- Flight Levels, Flight Levels Academy
- Product Development Project, Design Factory, Aalto University
- Lighting in Greenhouses and Vertical Farms, Wageningen University and Research (2018)

PUBLICATIONS

- **Co-author, Advances in Plant Factories** (Part 6, Ch. 20)
  Burleigh Dodds Science Publishing, 2023
- **Author, Lighting Units and Measurements in Plant Cultivation**
  Aalto University, 2014
- **Co-author, Valotusta tarpeen mukaan** (real-time dynamic lighting in cultivation)
  International Review of Civil Engineering, 2011

MEMBERSHIPS

- Member, International Society for Horticultural Science (ISHS)

LANGUAGES

Portuguese	Native
English	Full professional
Spanish	Advanced
French	Basic
Finnish	Beginner

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